

Wikinvest tracking \$1b portfolio

Wikinvest, a realtime portfolio tracker is tracking over \$1 billion worth of investments with three weeks of its launch

Popularity of Doom & Quake

Developers licensed core portions of the software used in making Doom & Quake games and added other game content such as own graphics, characters, weapons and levels

If the UPS has some problem and isn't supplying power properly, it might be causing the shutdown and startup problems. There's also a chance that the motherboard has some problem but it's difficult to diagnose that.

HDD crashing too often

I have a Compaq Presario V2565US. Whenever I start it, it shows SMART failure predicted errors on the hard disk. It tells to immediately backup the data and replace the hard disk drive. Recently, I had replaced my hard drive and now it is a 160 GB drive and I want to upgrade it further. Please solve my problem and suggest the hardware upgrades. I also want it to upgrade other components such as the RAM.

Gaganjot

It's difficult to judge what might be wrong. If the drive error problem keeps coming back, it might be to do with the drive controller and possibly not the drive. Still, it's difficult to conclude what the problem might be. You should take it to the HP-Compaq service centre. Make sure that they check the drive on a different system to check if the drive is the culprit. You already have 2 GB of RAM. Adding more isn't going to make your laptop a lot faster than that it is. You can go in for a hard drive upgrade if you are in need of more space. Look for a 250/320GB SATA drive from WD such as the WD Scorpio Blue.

FLV files won't play anymore

I have a problem with playing FLV files. My computer doesn't play the FLV files ever since I formatted it in the month of March 2010. Earlier, I didn't face any problems playing them. I am currently using the latest versions of KM player and VLC player. Please help sort out the problems.

Sandeep

It's a very strange problem. Install the latest drivers for your graphics card, and then try installing Media Player Classic - Home Cinema (<http://mpc-hc.sourceforge.net/>).



Media Player Classic - Home Cinema can handle a variety of formats without 3rd party plugins

DVDs don't read properly

My system configuration is as follows: Intel Dual Core processor, 128 Mb graphics card, LG DVD writer, 1 GB RAM. My PC problem is that my LG DVD writer isn't working properly. For instance, my PC recognises the writer as a CD-ROM but it plays DVD discs but not all. Earlier, it could play all DVD discs. Whenever I burn CDs, it burns successfully but when I insert the same disc, the writer shows it as a blank disc, the same thing happens to DVD disc. Help! I don't want to change my writer.

Muddas Ahmed

DVD drives get spoilt really quickly and that's what has happened to your drive most likely. The only solution is to get a replacement if it's under warranty period. If not, you need to buy one.

Do upgrades = slowdown?

I own an Acer Aspire 4930 laptop. The specifications are: Intel Core 2 Duo 2.00 GHz T5800 processor, 160 GB HDD, 2 GB RAM. I use multiple operating systems and now, I'm running out of memory. I wanted to know if it is possible to expand internal hard drive from 160 GB to 320 GB or 500 GB. Will there be any performance drop by doing so? I was told by a retailer that it is possible to expand internal drive, but I wanted expert's advice.

Kushal S. Pandya

Yes, it should be possible to upgrade your hard drive. There won't be a performance drop, but doing it yourself might void your warranty. Look for a WD or Seagate drive.

Repairing damaged board

My D935GNT motherboard is damaged a few days ago. Some parts on the board are damaged. It happened when the computer was running for about four hours and suddenly, it turned itself off. After that, it wouldn't turn back on. My motherboard is out of warranty. Is it possible to repair my motherboard? Intel said that they have no paid repair solution. My purchase date is 23 Aug 2006. Is there any motherboard for my Pentium D 820 processor?

Dhiman Chakrabarti

It's difficult for us to say if it's possible to repair your motherboard. You should take it to some local computer repair guy to see if they can fix it. The Pentium D is a really old processor. It might be difficult to find boards for it. Either way, look around for boards based on the Intel 945, 955, 965 and 975 chipsets.

Upgrading laptop components

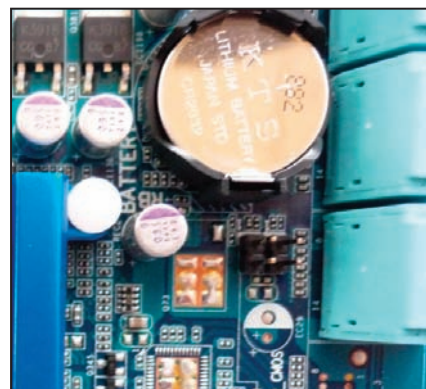
I'm using a 1.47GHz Intel Pentium powered laptop. I want to upgrade the processor and graphics card on the laptop to improve its speed. I have a total of 2 GB RAM.

Rocky Deswal

Upgrading your processor and graphics card on your laptop is not possible. There isn't enough space or even provision to do so. Looking at the configuration, it seems to be a very old laptop.

BIOS losing settings

I have an Intel DG31PR motherboard. The BIOS is troubling me. I need to change the boot order but no settings can be saved. When I save the settings, the system



The CMOS battery can be found on every board and is really simple to replace